

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting April 1st 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j1o38PRpStM
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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: April 1, 2024

Meeting Time: 9:01 AM

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(Not applicable. Omitted.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Delaware County Commissioners meeting to order on Monday, April 1, 2024, at 9:01 AM.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Commissioner Henry, Commissioner Reagan (President), Commissioner King.
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Commissioner Reagan (President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance. An open appointment for the Board of Zoning Appeals was announced, noting requirements for independent, non-elected members from either party.
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - Minutes for February 5, 2024: Motion made and seconded to remove from table and approved separately. (Roll call vote: Passed unanimously).
 - Minutes for February 20, 2024 and February 4th: Kept tabled for further review.
 - Minutes for March 18, 2024: Approved via roll call vote (Commissioners Henry and King "Yes", Commissioner Reagan "No").
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:10:07 Presentation: Muncie Land Bank Update & Property Requests**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nate Howard, Muncie Land Bank; accompanied by Jeb Reese (Intend Indiana) and Zach Bo.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented a progress report on seven properties awarded in July 2022 (averaging ~260 days to return to local hands via demolition, side-lot splits, and DIY rehabs). Outlined a new 2024 property request encompassing 43 properties total (24 in the Old West End with Intend Indiana and partner organizations to rehab/build 30<U+2013>35 homes; 11 vacant lots in the Industry neighborhood with Habitat for Humanity and other CDCs; and structures on South/May/Burn streets). Mentioned first-Friday monthly meetings and an upcoming housing summit at Ivy Tech.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None during this specific turn (general public comment occurred later).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; formal property transfer actions handled subsequently via resolutions.
- **00:19:39 Presentation: Delaware County Historical Society Bicentennial & Centennial Planning**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Karen Vincent (County Historian) and Zach Bo (President, Delaware County Historical Society).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Highlighted upcoming milestones: dchs Centennial in 2025 and Delaware County Bicentennial in 2027. Requested initial seed money (\$15,000) to help build a dedicated website, establish initial stakeholder meetings, and form a steering committee.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Commissioner King moved to donate \$15,000 to the Historical Society to start the process; seconded. **Approved by Roll Call Vote (3-0).**

- **00:26:27 Presentation: Community Connect App Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff Hansard, Chief Probation Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Provided an update on the "Community Connect App," a comprehensive digital intake and referral portal for social services, re-entry, probation, and community use. Reported that the Board of Health agreed to fund 50% (\$6,400) of the \$12,800 total deployment cost, contingent on city/county funding splits.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; no direct board action or funding vote requested at this time.
- **00:37:24 00:37:24 American Rescue Plan (ARP) Fund Reallocation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Administration / Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to move \$200,000 of previously appropriated American Rescue Plan (ARP) funds from the mental health building project to Revenue Replacement, specifically designated as disaster relief to assist the town of Selma with tornado recovery expenses. Noted that the state legislature expanded funding options for the mental health facility, offsetting local costs.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to approve. **Approved by Roll Call Vote (3-0).**
- **00:39:12 00:39:16 Resolution 2024-03: Identification of Properties for Nonprofit Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John Brook, Attorney / Board of Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution to remove from table and identify certain properties/tax sale certificates to be transferred to the Muncie Land Bank pursuant to Indiana Code.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to remove from table (**Approved 3-0**). Motion and second to approve Resolution 2024-03. **Approved by Roll Call Vote (3-0).**
- **00:40:57 Resolution 2024-04: Deed Transfers for Land Bank Properties**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John Brook, Attorney / Board of Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution executing deeds for two specific properties already in the name of the Commissioners to be transferred directly to the Muncie Land Bank.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to approve Resolution 2024-04. **Approved by Roll Call Vote (3-0).**
- **00:44:58 IT Department: Justice Center Internet Upgrade**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jim Fluk, IT Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requested permission to upgrade AT&T internet service at the Justice Center (where the majority of the workforce and Odyssey database users are located) from 500 Mbps to 1 Gigabit, representing an annual cost increase of \$3,200.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to permit the upgrade. **Approved by Roll Call Vote (3-0).**
 - **00:46:58 Recorder / Auditor Office: Document Scanning Contracts**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jan Misner, County Recorder (with input from Auditor/Administration and Fiddler).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Initially presented a request regarding document scanning projects for the Recorder and Auditor offices using ARP funds, but elected to withdraw general ARP fund requests in light of Selma tornado relief needs. County administration and legal counsel proposed approving the Fiddler scanning contracts anyway, with funding to be identified internally within department funds.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion and second to approve the Fiddler contracts for the scanning projects. **Approved by Roll Call Vote (3-0).**
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:51:48 Lindsay Arthur**
 - *Affiliation:* CEO, Muncie Habitat for Humanity.
 - *Key Concerns:* Spoke in strong support of the Muncie Land Bank's property transfer requests. Noted that Habitat plans to use 10 properties in the Industry neighborhood for new home construction over a next-year grant cycle with the Federal Home Loan Bank of Indianapolis, emphasizing the critical role land banks play for small local nonprofits.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Community Corrections:** Jane Miranda submitted annual support letters for DOC grants (due April 12).
 - **Emergency Management (John Cino):** Noted upcoming assistance group sessions at the EOC (April 3<U+2013>4) for departments deploying assets to Selma or Winchester. Announced a Small Business Administration (SBA) Disaster Loan Outreach Center opening at the Selma American Legion.
 - **Treasurer (Brad Hunt):** Reported that property tax statements will be mailed out next week, projecting ~\$120 million in collections, and noted \$600,000 in investment interest earned over the first two months of the year.
 - **Adjournment:** Motion and second to recess/adjourn. **Approved by Roll Call Vote (3-0)** at **00:54:02** (exact final session clock time not explicitly read aloud).
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